Your Zodiacal Releasing, Explained

Your Zodiacal Releasing, Explained From The Ground Up

Prepared 2026-09-27 for Austin

First — what is Zodiacal Releasing?

Zodiacal Releasing (ZR) is an ancient Greek timing technique. It comes from a 2nd-century astrologer named **Vettius Valens**, in a text called the *Anthology* (Book IV). It was almost completely lost for centuries and was recovered and translated into modern practice in the last thirty years, largely through the work of Robert Schmidt (Project Hindsight) and Chris Brennan.

The idea is simple, even if the mechanics look complicated at first:

Your life is divided into chapters. Each chapter has a ruler. The ruler tells you what the chapter is about.

The chapters are called *periods*. They start when you're born and unfold in a fixed sequence for the rest of your life. Some are long (25 years), some are very short (a few days). They nest inside each other like Russian dolls — a big chapter contains medium chapters contains small chapters contains very small chapters. Astrologers call these **Level 1 (L1), Level 2 (L2), Level 3 (L3), and Level 4 (L4)**.

- **L1** is the biggest chapter you're in — think of it as the *era* of your life.
- **L2** is the sub-chapter within that era — think *year-scale*, sometimes 2–3 years.
- **L3** is a shorter movement within the L2 — think *month-scale*.
- **L4** is very short — a *few-days-scale* mood.

Each period is ruled by a sign of the zodiac and, therefore, by that sign's planet. So if the L2 period you're in is *Aquarius*, then Saturn (Aquarius's ruler) is running that sub-chapter of your life. Whatever Saturn means in your natal chart — where he sits, what he's connected to, whether he's dignified or afflicted — becomes the flavor of that period.

Two starting points. You can release from either of two calculated points in the chart:

- **Lot of Spirit** — traditionally read as your *career, direction of action, the arc of the soul's work in the world*. This is the one we're using for you.
- **Lot of Fortune** — traditionally read as your *body, health, livelihood, material life, the arc of your circumstances*.

Different questions, different starting Lot. For "what's happening in the trajectory of my work and calling," we release from Spirit. That's what I've been referring to in previous readings.

Sources for what I just said: Valens, *Anthology* IV.1–13 (the original); Chris Brennan, *Hellenistic Astrology* (2017), ch. 17 (the best modern treatment); Demetra George, *Ancient Astrology in Theory and Practice*, Vol. II (forthcoming/partial), also good.

Two concepts you need before the reading

Two ideas do most of the heavy lifting. Once you have these two, the rest reads itself.

1. Peak periods

Each of your periods is ruled by a sign. When that sign happens to fall in an *angular* house *counted from your Lot of Spirit* — that is, the 1st, 4th, 7th, or 10th sign from Spirit — the period is called a **peak period**.

Peaks are exactly what they sound like: the periods where the trajectory *rises to a summit*. Career-visible moments, career-defining moments, moments where public reputation or vocation is loud. Not always good (a peak can be a peak of crisis), but always *significant*.

Your Lot of Spirit is at **17° Taurus 32'**, in your natal 11th house. Counting from Taurus:

- **1st sign from Spirit** = Taurus (peak — ruled by Venus)
- **4th sign from Spirit** = Leo (peak — ruled by the Sun)
- **7th sign from Spirit** = Scorpio (peak — ruled by Mars)
- **10th sign from Spirit** = Aquarius (peak — ruled by Saturn)

Any period ruled by one of these four signs is a peak. Every other period (Gemini, Cancer, Virgo, Libra, Sagittarius, Capricorn, Pisces, Aries) is *non-peak* — either background weather, buildup, or aftermath.

2. Loosing of the Bond

Sometimes the natural sequence of periods "jumps" — the release breaks its pattern and moves to a completely different sign, usually the sign *opposite* where it would have gone. This is called a **Loosing of the Bond** (LB — Valens's phrase, translated). It's a technical marker for *the trajectory pivots here, the previous arc completes, a new arc opens*.

LBs are structurally important. In Valens they're marked as points of *dramatic change* — a person's life-story literally taking a turn. Modern practitioners (Brennan especially) treat them as legitimate structural inflection points but caution against reading them as always dramatic-in-a-cinematic sense. Sometimes it's a quiet turn. But it is a turn.

Now — your chart, right now, this week

Here is exactly where you are, in all four levels, on Sunday 2026-09-27:

Level	Sign	Ruler	Started	Ends	Angularity	Peak?	LB?
L1 (era)	**Cancer**	**Moon**	2014-12-07	2039-07-29	3rd from Spirit (cadent)	no	no
L2 (sub-chapter)	**Aquarius**	**Saturn**	2025-04-13	2027-09-30	10th from Spirit (**angular**)	**YES**	no
L3 (short movement)	**Leo**	**Sun**	2026-09-23	2026-11-09	4th from Spirit (**angular**)	**YES**	**YES**
L4 (few-day mood)	**Virgo**	**Mercury**	2026-09-27 (today!)	2026-10-01	5th from Spirit	no	no

Level	Sign	Ruler	Started	Ends	Angularity (succedent)	Peak?	LB?

Let me read each one out, plain-English, starting with the biggest.

L1: You are in a Cancer era, ruled by the Moon, until 2039.

Started: December 2014. **Ends:** July 2039. **That's 25 years of Cancer.**

Cancer's ruler is the Moon. In *your* natal chart, the Moon is your **Lord of the Ascendant** — the ruler of your whole chart — and she sits at 15° Cancer *in her own sign*, right on your Ascendant, in your 1st house. So the era you're in isn't just any 25-year chapter — it is *the era ruled by the single most important planet in your chart, sitting in her strongest position, on the most personal point you have*.

Translated: **the 25 years from age 27 to age 52 are the years your life is most fully yours to shape.** You're eleven years into it. What you build now stays. What you don't build now, you have to build later.

Cancer as an era's flavor: *home, family, care, the ground under the feet, roots, ancestry, the body, protection, nourishment, the private life, the practitioner.* Everything Cancer signifies. Cancer is the sign of your natal 1st house — so this era is *making the life you actually live match the person you actually are*.

Angularity note: Cancer sits 3rd from Spirit — a non-peak, cadent position. That sounds bad but isn't; it means *the era itself is not a peak of external visibility*. The era isn't about being famous. It's about *becoming*. The peaks come inside it (see next).

No Loosing of the Bond in the era. The era runs cleanly to 2039.

L2: You are in a peak Aquarius / Saturn sub-chapter, right now.

Started: April 2025 (about 18 months ago). **Ends:** September 2027 (about a year from now). **Total length:** 2.5 years.

This is the loudest thing on your entire timeline for the next four years. Let me explain why.

Remember: the *sub-chapter* is ruled by its sign's planet, and it is a **peak** when its sign is angular from Spirit. Aquarius is 10th from your Spirit — the *very top* — the peak position that traditionally correlates with *career-visibility, public standing, and the summit of an arc*. Ruler: Saturn.

Saturn in your natal chart sits in your 6th house (work, service, the body, daily labor), retrograde, conjunct Uranus. So the peak L2 you're in is ruled by *the natal Saturn of your 6th house*. This is why I've been telling you the year is loud in the direction of career/vocation. It is technically loud. This is not weather; this is *structure*.

What a peak L2 does: it correlates historically with *career-defining, calling-defining, public-facing events*. In Valens's examples in the *Anthology*, peak L2 periods are when people become known for what they do, take on a title, enter a new station, or lose one. In modern practice (Brennan's collection of case studies, and the material George teaches), peak L2s consistently show up as the periods when major-life-career-things happen — a book gets published, a business gets founded, a person finally takes the position they'd been circling.

Two anchors for you specifically:

- **You started this peak L2 in April 2025.** That's roughly when the "commute isn't sustainable / I need a school closer to home" thinking started to become a live topic. That is *not a coincidence*. The peak began, and the trajectory started pushing on you.
- **You end this peak L2 in September 2027.** Which means everything about the work situation — where you teach, how you teach, what shape your daily-labor life has — is *on the table for reconfiguration in this 2.5-year window and not on the same terms after it*. You're in the working-out phase of a career peak that lasts one more year.

Sect matters here. Saturn is your *malefic of sect* (the mild malefic for a day chart) — meaning Saturn is *the constructive-but-serious* planet in your chart. He is not a cruel visitor. He is the discipline-and-consequence teacher. A peak period ruled by your in-sect Saturn is more likely to feel like *earning something the hard way* than *being punished*. You are not being punished. You are being asked to build honestly.

One more note. Because Aquarius is *retrograde-Saturn territory* (natal Saturn is retrograde in Sag, ruling Aquarius), this peak has a *revising, redoing, going-back-through* character built into it. This peak's Saturn is not the Saturn of *first-time construction* — it's the Saturn of *reconstruction, correction, the second attempt done right*. Read: what you're being asked to build now is likely a re-do of something you already tried once. The new school is not a *first* move — it's a *revision* of the first move you made when you took the current one.

L3: You just entered a peak Leo / Sun movement, with a Loosing of the Bond flag.

Started: September 23, 2026 — four days ago. Right around the equinox. **Ends:** November 9, 2026. **Total length:** ~47 days.

Two things make this L3 unusual, both loud.

First: it's a peak inside a peak.

The L3 sign is Leo. Leo is *4th from your Spirit* — another angular position, another peak. So right now you are in a **peak sub-chapter (Aquarius L2) inside your era, with a peak short-movement (Leo L3) inside that.** Peaks stacking on peaks is what astrologers call a *pileup* — the moments when the trajectory really compresses.

This 47-day window (late Sep through early Nov 2026) is astrologically **the most concentrated peak signal you will experience** in this entire 2.5-year L2. It's the peak inside the peak. Anything that happens career-and-calling-shaped during this window has an *amplified* weight relative to the L2 average.

Leo's ruler is the **Sun**. In your natal chart, the Sun sits at 12° Taurus in your 11th house — the sect light of a day chart, in the same sign as your Lot of Spirit. So this L3 is ruled by *the planet that is both the light of your chart and the co-tenant of your Spirit*. Read: *the light comes on. Whatever is happening in this window is meant to be seen — by you first, by others potentially.*

Second: it is a Loosing of the Bond.

This L3 carries the LB flag. That means the trajectory *pivots* here. Not necessarily explosively. But the pattern that has been running changes. In Valens, LBs are marked as *turning points of story.*

Read together: you are in a peak-inside-a-peak, ruled by the Sun, with the LB pivot flag, from September 23 through November 9. **This is the sky's way of saying: this window is a hinge. Whatever you are working out about your career and calling during these seven weeks is not background weather. It is a turn.**

And notice the calendar overlap: the Venus retrograde starts October 3 and runs through November 13. **The Venus retrograde falls almost entirely inside this peak-inside-a-peak LB window.** The two techniques don't share a common source — Zodiacal Releasing is Valens (2nd century, symbolic time) and the Venus retrograde is a real astronomical event tracked by transits — and they are pointing at the same seven-week window from two different angles. This is what practitioners call *technique confirmation*. When two independent methods light up the same period, take the period seriously.

L4: Today is a Virgo / Mercury micro-period — 4 days long.

Started: Sunday September 27, 2:21 AM UTC (roughly overnight last night). **Ends:** Thursday October 1, ~6:21 AM UTC. **Total length:** 4 days.

L4 is the *mood-of-the-week* level — it's too short to change anything structural, but it colors the days. This L4 is ruled by Mercury. In your natal chart, Mercury is at 8° Taurus (11th house — same neighborhood as your Sun and Lot of Spirit).

Virgo sits *5th from your Spirit* — succedent, not a peak. So this micro-period is *not* itself a peak; it's more like a corridor. Mercury-ruled L4s consistently correlate (in Brennan's teaching and in what I've observed in my own tracking) with *thinking, writing, communicating, arranging, organizing, negotiating, corresponding*. Mental work. Message-work.

Read: **today through Thursday morning, the underlying flavor of your days is *think, write, correspond, arrange, plan.*** Which is exactly what the transit picture is asking you to do (front-load school applications and outreach Sun/Mon; research and hard conversations Tue–Thu). The L4 and the transits are agreeing.

When this L4 ends Thursday morning, the next L4 will be **Libra / Venus** (~4 days) — which lands you exactly on the Venus retrograde station on Saturday. In other words: **the L4 that starts Thursday morning hands the mood of your life over to Venus for the moment she stations retrograde.** Again, the techniques are agreeing.

What all this means — the honest read

Put it all together and it says one thing very clearly.

You are in the summit of a career/calling arc that started April 2025 and ends September 2027, and you have just entered the loudest 47 days of that summit. The 47 days coincide with the Venus retrograde. Your Lord of the Year (Venus) is retrograding on your natal Pluto during a peak-inside-a-peak Loosing-of-the-Bond period ruled by Saturn (era-within-an-era) and lit by the Sun (the immediate movement). Your progressed Moon is completing a two-year daily-labor chapter and applying to natal Saturn. Every layer of the technique is pointing at the same thing.

What the layers are saying, together:

1. **The trajectory is turning.** Not "might turn." *Is turning*. The Loosing of the Bond flag is the technical marker for exactly that.
2. **The turn is career/vocation-shaped.** Every peak in your ZR from Spirit is a career signal. Peaks stacking on peaks means the turn is loud in exactly this direction.
3. **The turn favors reconstruction over invention.** Saturn's presence (as L2 lord, as the planet your progressed Moon is approaching) means the move being asked for is *fixing what didn't work the first time*, not *starting from nothing*. The next school is a revision of the current one, done with what you now know.
4. **The window is not indefinite.** You are inside the peak from now through November 9 (L3), inside the LB pivot from now through November 9 (structural turn), and inside the larger L2 peak through September

2027 (the "you can still make big career moves and have them land" window). You have time — but not infinite time — to make the change.

5. **The decision itself belongs to the November-through-mid-December window, per the Venus retrograde read.** The peak-inside-a-peak is the *pressure and clarity* window (through Nov 9). The Venus direct station (Nov 13) is the *decision-clarity* moment. The final Venus/Pluto pass (Dec 15) is the *resolution* moment. And then the Capricorn ingress of your progressed Moon in March 2027 is when whatever you've chosen becomes structural fact.

One more thing worth naming. After this L3 ends on November 9, the next L3 within your Aquarius L2 will be **Virgo / Mercury** (2026-11-09 → ~2027-01-06). That's a non-peak, workmanlike sub-movement — *doing the actual work of arranging what the peak-inside-a-peak clarified*. Translation: the fireworks are now; the arrangement-and-execution phase begins November 10 and runs about two months. If you're deciding, you're deciding in the fireworks window. If you're implementing, you're implementing in the workmanlike window that follows. The technique is drawing the timeline for you.

The larger arc — what's after 2027

Because you asked me to explain the significance of the *current* ZR, I've stayed mostly on what you're inside of right now. But the next moves are worth naming briefly, because they contextualize why the current peak matters so much:

- **September 2027 → April 2028:** The Aquarius L2 ends. You enter a **Pisces L2 (ruled by Jupiter)**. Non-peak. Jupiter is your *benefic of sect* — the softest, most-helpful planet in your chart. This is a receiving-the-gift period, a settling, an *"okay, the reconfiguration is done, live in it"* period.
- **April 2028 → December 2029: Aries L2 (ruled by Mars)**. Non-peak. Mars is your *malefic contrary to sect* — the harshest planet in your chart. Not a peak but not a soft period; a *push-through-friction* period. Aries is the sign of your natal 10th (career). Ruled by Mars in your 12th (natally). Whatever you built in the current peak has to prove itself in this window.
- **December 2029 → August 2030: Taurus L2 (ruled by Venus) — PEAK.** Your next major career-visibility summit. Ruled by Venus, in her own domicile Taurus, sitting in the 11th of *friends, patrons, community*. This is the "the thing you built is recognized by your people" peak.

So the current peak (through Sep 2027) is the *build the thing* peak. The next peak (Dec 2029 → Aug 2030) is the *recognized-for-the-thing* peak. The years between are for the thing to become itself.

Read the current window in that context. You are not choosing what school to teach at. You are choosing what your career looks like for the next four years, which will be the four years leading up to your next major visibility peak.

That is what your Zodiacal Releasing is currently saying.

Sources

- Valens, Vettius. *Anthology*, Book IV. (Original source.) Translation by Mark Riley (freely available; Riley's translation is the standard scholarly text).
- Brennan, Chris. *Hellenistic Astrology: The Study of Fate and Fortune*. Amor Fati, 2017. Chapter 17 is the best plain-English treatment of Zodiacal Releasing in print.
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- Schmidt, Robert. *The Astrological Record of the Early Sages*. Project Hindsight. (For the recovery-of-technique history.)

All positions and period boundaries from the swisseph-astro skill; verified against your natal chart at `natal-chart.md`.

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